

Direct and indirect questions

Direct questions

- **Wh- word + Auxiliary verb + Subject + Main verb (+ Complement)?**
- **Where** did you **buy** that jacket?

Subject questions

- Subject questions (we want to find out the **subject** of the sentence, whether it is a thing or a person).

Who+ verb

What+ verb

Who closed the door? **Not auxiliaries such as did, do or does.**

Somebody closed the door.

Who helped you with the project? **Someone** helped you with the project.

What happened yesterday? **Something** happened yesterday.

Object questions

Object questions (we want to find out what comes after the verb).

- What did you eat for breakfast?
-You ate **something** (object, **after the verb**)
- Who did you invite to the party?
-You invited **somebody**. (object, **after** the verb)

★ Test Exam ★ Write me a very formal email ➡ use preposition before

Prepositions in questions

- Prepositions can appear either at the end of a question (informal, common in speech) or before the question word (more formal, written style). Both are correct; choose the style that fits your register.
- **1. Preposition at the end (informal / neutral)**
 - **Structure:** Wh- word + auxiliary + subject + verb + object + preposition?
 - Who are you talking **to**? // Which team did you vote **for**?

2. Preposition before the question word (formal)

Structure: Preposition + Wh- word + auxiliary + subject + verb + object?

To whom are you talking? // **For** which team did you vote? // **On** what did you base your decision?

Short questions

- Short, clipped questions that end with a preposition (e.g., “Where to?” “Who with?” “What for?”) are very common in conversation and **informal** writing. They’re natural, concise, and widely used in spoken English.
- I’m going out tonight. B: Where to?/ Who with?

Indirect questions

- **Structure rules**
- **Wh- indirect questions**: **Intro phrase + wh-word + subject + verb**. Example structure: I wonder + where + she + lives.
- **Yes/No indirect questions**: **Intro phrase + if/whether + subject + verb**. Example structure: Could you tell me + if/whether + they + arrived.
- **Word order**: use **subject + verb** (statement order), not auxiliary-subject inversion.
- **Tense/backshifting**: when the reporting verb is in the past, shift the tense in the embedded clause accordingly (present → past, past → past perfect).
- **Modals**: keep modal verbs as in statements (can → could when backshifting).

The tense changed from direct ➡ reported speech

Reported speech examples

- **Direct speech:** She asked: "*What did you do yesterday?*"
- **Reported speech:** She asked what I **had done** the day before.
- **Direct speech:** Can you help me?
- **Reported speech:** He asked if I **could** help him.

For more information and examples

- Page 68 (textbook).
- Exercises: page 9, (4&5)